

EAM310 · EAM DIAGNOSIS I · VUIM · SUMMER 2026

Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Prof. Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac.

Week 3 · Pulse Diagnosis · Summer 2026

Jonathan Centeno · D.AcHM Candidate · VUIM 2026–2030

Read this before Quiz 3. Every answer is here.

Highest-yield facts only — for last-minute review, not first-pass learning.

1 Positions · Method · Normal

SIX POSITIONS?

L: Cùn=HT(SI) · Guān=LR(GB) · Chǐ=KD(BL) | R: Cùn=LU(LI) · Guān=SP(ST) · Chǐ=PC(TB)

FIVE FINGER MOVEMENTS?

Lifting (superficial) · Pressing (deep) · Searching (rate) · Pushing (shape) · Rolling (length). Maciocia box lists 4 — know all 5.

NORMAL PULSE — 胃神根?

胃 Wèi = flowing/gentle · 神 Shén = strong/rhythmical · 根 Gēn = rooted, deep at Chǐ

NORMAL RATE?

4–5 beats per breath, 60–90bpm. Counted against the PRACTITIONER's breath.

8 COMPONENTS OF A NORMAL PULSE?

Width · Depth · Rate · Rhythm · Strength · Length · Tension · Shape

2 Seasonal — Trap Territory

ALL FOUR SEASONAL PULSES?

Spring=Wiry 弦 (Feb 4–May 4) · Summer=Flooding 洪 (May 5–Aug 6) · Autumn=Hair-like 毛 (Aug 7–Nov 6) · Winter=Stone 石 (Nov 7–Feb 3)

WHEN IS A SEASONAL PULSE ABNORMAL?

When other signs/symptoms accompany it. Flooding in WINTER = warning sign (Schrier's cerebral hemorrhage case), not a seasonal variant.

3 The Core Combinations

FLOATING + ?

Tight=Ext Wind-Cold · Rapid=Ext Wind-Heat · Empty=Summer-Heat OR Yin Def (degree differentiates) · Slippery=Wind-Damp/Phlegm · Weak=External-Empty, weak Wei Qi

DEEP + ?

Slow=Int Cold · Rapid=Int Heat · Weak=Yang Def · Wiry=Blood Stasis/Chong Mai · Soggy-Slow=Int Dampness

SLOW + ?

Weak=Empty-Cold/Yang Def · Full=Full Cold (chronic pain) · Choppy=Blood Def + Int Cold · Slippery=Cold-Phlegm · Wiry=Cold in Liver channel

RAPID + ?

Full=Full Heat · Empty=Empty Heat (Yin Def) · Wiry=Liver Fire · Slippery=Phlegm-Heat · Overflowing=Full Heat

4 ⚠ The Traps

FLOATING ≠ ALWAYS EXTERIOR

Also Yin Deficiency — Yin fails to anchor Yang. Presents Floating+Thin+Rapid with night sweats, five-palm heat, malar flush, dry throat worse at night. **Differentiator:** true Exterior floating has SIMULTANEOUS aversion to cold + fever. Lose that pairing → pathogen moved Interior.

HUǍN IS THE HEALTHY ONE

Slowed-Down/Moderate 緩 = 4 beats/breath, faster than Slow = **generally a healthy pulse**. The only qualitatively normal entry among the 28. Easy to misread as Slow.

IRREGULAR RHYTHM — THE THREE-WAY SPLIT

Knotted 結 = SLOW + random stops → Cold w/ Heart-Yang Def. **Hasty** 促 = RAPID + random stops → Severe Heat / Heart-Fire. **Intermittent** 代 = pauses at REGULAR intervals → most serious; internal organ / Heart problem.

5 All 28 — One Line Each

Quality	Indication
1. Floating 浮	Invasion of external Wind. Yin Deficiency (interior condition presenting superficially).
2. Deep / Submerged 沉	Pathogenic factor in the Interior (Deep-Full). Yang Deficiency (Deep-Weak).
3. Slow 遲	Cold pattern. Empty-Cold (Slow+Weak). Full-Cold (Slow+Full).
4. Rapid 數	Heat pattern. Full-Heat (Rapid+Full). Empty-Heat (Rapid+Floating-Empty).
5. Empty / Deficient 虛	Qi Deficiency.
6. Full / Excessive 實	Full pattern. Full-Heat (Full+Rapid). Full-Cold (Full+Slow).
7. Slippery 滑	Phlegm. Dampness. Retention of food. Pregnancy.
8. Choppy 澀	Blood Deficiency. Exhaustion of Body Fluids.
9. Long 長	Heat patterns.

Quality	Indication
10. Short 短	Severe Qi Deficiency. Stomach-Qi Deficiency.
11. Overflowing / Flooding 洪	Full-Heat. Empty-Heat (Overflowing-Empty).
12. Fine / Thin 細	Blood Deficiency. Dampness with severe Qi Deficiency.
13. Minute / Faint 微	Severe deficiency of Qi and Blood.
14. Tight 緊	Cold — Exterior (Tight-Floating), Interior Full-Cold (Tight-Full-Deep), Interior Empty-Cold (Tight-Weak-Deep). Pain.
15. Wiry 弦	Liver disharmony. Pain. Phlegm.
16. Slowed-Down / Moderate 緩	Generally a HEALTHY pulse — the one qualitatively normal entry on this list.
17. Hollow 芤	Hemorrhage. Forthcoming hemorrhage (Hollow+Rapid). Yin Deficiency.
18. Leather 革	Severe Kidney-Essence Deficiency. Severe Kidney-Yin Deficiency.
19. Firm / Confined 牢	Blood Stasis. Interior Cold (Firm+Slow). Pain.
20. Soggy 濡	Dampness with Qi Deficiency. Yin Deficiency. Essence Deficiency.
21. Weak / Frail 弱	Yang Deficiency. Blood Deficiency.
22. Scattered 散	Severe Qi and Blood Deficiency. Severe Kidney-Qi Deficiency. A serious condition.
23. Hidden 伏	Severe Yang Deficiency.
24. Moving 動	Shock, anxiety, fright. Pain.
25. Hasty 促	Severe Heat. Deficiency of Heart-Qi. Heart-Fire.
26. Knotted 結	Cold with Heart-Yang Deficiency.
27. Intermittent 代	Serious problem in the internal organs. Heart problem (Western medical sense).
28. Hurried / Racing 疾	Fire exhausting Yin.

PART B • Quick Reference — Carry This

One job: name it, place it, say what it means.

Fold or print double-sided and carry it. This is the whole 28 compressed to the minimum that still lets you answer a question. Use the Workbook when you need depth; use this when you need speed.

1 The 28 — Minimum Viable Version

#	Char	Tell	Means
1. Floating	浮 Fú	Wood floating on the surface of water; a subtle breeze across a bird's back; scallion leaves rolled lightly between the fingers.	Invasion of external Wind.
2. Deep / Submerged	沉 Chén	A stone thrown into a well, sinking to the bottom.	Pathogenic factor in the Interior (Deep-Full).
3. Slow	遲 Chí	Fewer than three beats per breath, about 40–60bpm, regular rhythm.	Cold pattern.
4. Rapid	數 Shuò	Over five beats per breath, 90–140bpm, regular rhythm.	Heat pattern.
5. Empty / Deficient	虛 Xū	A water balloon — big on the outside, nothing solid when you press in.	Qi Deficiency.
6. Full / Excessive	實 Shí	Felt at all three positions and all three depths	Full pattern.
7. Slippery	滑 Huá	A pearl rolling on a plate; a raindrop gliding off a leaf.	Phlegm.
8. Choppy	澀 Sè	Scraping bamboo with a small knife.	Blood Deficiency.
9. Long	長 Cháng	Smooth and straight	Heat patterns.
10. Short	短 Duǎn	Cannot be felt in all three positions	Severe Qi Deficiency.
11. Overflowing / Flooding	洪 Hóng	Ocean waves that come strongly but leave calmly.	Full-Heat.
12. Fine / Thin	細 Xì	Angel-hair pasta rather than a thick udon noodle.	Blood Deficiency.
13. Minute / Faint	微 Wēi	Now you see it, now you don't.	Severe deficiency of Qi and Blood.
14. Tight	緊 Jǐn	Fingers on a highly stretched twisted cord, snapping back and forth.	Cold — Exterior (Tight-Floating), Interior Full-Cold (Tight-Full-Deep), Interior Empty-Cold (Tight-Weak-Deep).
15. Wiry	弦 Xián	A spring stretched on a musical instrument; a guitar string about to snap.	Liver disharmony.
16. Slowed-Down / Moderate	緩 Huǎn	Beats four times per breath — faster than the Slow pulse.	Generally a HEALTHY pulse — the one qualitatively normal entry on this list.

#	Char	Tell	Means
17. Hollow	芤 Kōu	A scallion stalk — has an edge but is hollow inside.	Hemorrhage.
18. Leather	革 Gé	The surface of a drum — thick on top, hollow beneath.	Severe Kidney-Essence Deficiency.
19. Firm / Confined	牢 Láo	Deep, taut, long, wide, and forceful	Blood Stasis.
20. Soggy	濡 Rú	A strand of cotton floating on water; a bubble that bursts under light pressure.	Dampness with Qi Deficiency.
21. Weak / Frail	弱 Ruò	Forceless, deep, and thin	Yang Deficiency.
22. Scattered	散 Sǎn	Flower blossoms lightly scattering to the ground.	Severe Qi and Blood Deficiency.
23. Hidden	伏 Fú	Pulsation seeming to come from beneath the bone and tendons.	Severe Yang Deficiency.
24. Moving	動 Dòng	A bean bouncing in the vessel — well-defined peaks, no head or tail.	Shock, anxiety, fright.
25. Hasty	促 Cù	Agitated and urgent, like a man running and suddenly falling down.	Severe Heat.
26. Knotted	結 Jié	Slow with irregularly missed beats	Cold with Heart-Yang Deficiency.
27. Intermittent	代 Dài	Pauses at REGULAR intervals	Serious problem in the internal organs.
28. Hurried / Racing	疾 Jí	Rapid, beating more than seven times per breath (140–180bpm) — an extreme version of Rapid	Fire exhausting Yin.

2 Sorted By What You Actually Felt

If you felt...	Candidates
At the surface	Floating · Soggy · Leather · Scattered · Hollow
Only deep	Deep · Firm · Hidden · Weak
Fast	Rapid · Hurried/Racing · Moving · Slippery · Hasty
Slow	Slow · Choppy · Knotted · <i>Huǎn (but this one is healthy)</i>
Forceful	Full · Overflowing · Tight · Firm · Long
Forceless	Empty · Minute · Weak · Soggy · Scattered · Fine
Narrow	Fine · Minute · Choppy
Wide	Overflowing · Empty · Hollow · Leather · Scattered · Big
Taut	Wiry (straight line) · Tight (vibrates side to side)
Irregular rhythm	Knotted (slow+random) · Hasty (rapid+random) · Intermittent (regular pauses)
Hollow underneath	Hollow (soft surface) · Leather (forceful surface)

3 The Five You Must Own First

Schrier's Week 3 instruction — literally

"Don't worry about wiry. We haven't gotten there. **Only floating, deep, slow, rapid, full.** Work with each other. Start noticing."

Everything else on this sheet is for the written exam. These five are for your fingers.

Pulse	What you're feeling for	Confirm by asking
Floating	Meets you at the surface; press and it dips, release and it bounces back up	Chills + fever together? Stiff neck? Stuffy nose?
Deep	Nothing at the top; only appears near the bone	Do you run cold? Chronic or recent?
Slow	Under 3 beats per your breath	Do you generally run cold? Feel their hands and forearm.
Rapid	Over 5 beats per your breath	Thirsty? Feeling of heat? Easy to break a sweat? Red tongue / yellow coat?
Full	Forceful at all three depths and all three positions	Is anything aggravated by pressure?

4 Three Traps

Trap	Correction
Floating = Exterior	Also Yin Def. Exterior needs simultaneous chills + fever. No pairing → look at Yin Def.
Slow-looking = Slow	Count it. 4 beats/breath is Huǎn — healthy , not Slow (under 3).
Irregular = irregular	Three different pulses. Slow+random = Knotted. Rapid+random = Hasty. Regular pauses = Intermittent (most serious).